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2027 CYCLE

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CUET UG

Political Science

Era of One-Party Dominance

Official Syllabus · Politics in India Since Independence · Class 12 · CUET UG 2027 Cycle Notes

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Syllabus Alignment

Sub-topic	Official syllabus pointer (NTA CUET(UG) Political Science syllabus 2026, the current 2027 baseline — Politics in India Since Independence)	Skills the questions test
First three general elections	First three general elections — the 1951-52, 1957 and 1962 rounds, held on the basis of universal adult franchise	Recalling the scale, dates, results and the voting landmark of 1951-52.
Nature of Congress dominance	Nature of Congress dominance at the national level, uneven dominance at the state level	Explaining why one party won everywhere, and naming the states where it did not.
Coalitional nature of Congress	Coalitional nature of Congress. Major opposition parties	Identifying the rainbow character of the Congress and each opposition party's founders, ideas and record.

EXAM PATTERN

CUET UG pattern (NTA official information bulletin and syllabus, 2026 cycle — the current 2027 baseline): each subject paper carries **50 compulsory questions** in **60 minutes**, with +5 for every correct answer and −1 for every incorrect answer. The Political Science paper follows NCERT Class 12 texts — this unit is fact-and-year country: election numbers, party founding dates and the Kerala 1957-59 sequence reward precise recall.

A New Nation Learns to Vote

On 15 August 1947 India became independent — but independence arrived bleeding. Partition had split Bengal and Punjab, killed somewhere near a million people and forced over a million refugees across new borders. The new government had to feed people, resettle families, absorb princely states AND design a political system. The writers of the Constitution then made a choice that still amazes historians: they gave the vote to **every adult**, on day one.

- **Universal adult franchise — the boldest decision:**
  - **The rule (Article 326):** every man and woman aged 21 or above could vote — no property test, no literacy test, no gender bar, no religious bar.
  - **The context makes it huge:** India's literacy in 1951 was barely 18%. Most new voters had never seen a ballot, many had never held a pen.

- **The contrast:** many older democracies had spent decades, even centuries, extending the vote to the poor and to women. India gave everyone the vote BEFORE it gave everyone schooling — the reverse of the usual path.
- **The principle:** one person, one vote, one value — the poorest labourer's vote weighed exactly as much as a Maharaja's.

- **The machinery had to be built from zero:**
  - **Election Commission of India:** set up on 25 January 1950 as an independent constitutional authority (Article 324) — free from government control so no ruling party could tilt the field.
  - **Sukumar Sen:** the first Chief Election Commissioner, who ran the impossible logistics of 1951-52.
  - **The scale:** more than **17 crore** eligible voters choosing **489 Members of the Lok Sabha** and about **3,200 Members of Legislative Assemblies** — the two elections held TOGETHER in one giant exercise.
  - **The obstacle:** roughly **85% of voters could not read or write** — a written ballot would have shut them out.
  - **The fix — symbols:** every party got a symbol (the Congress's pair of bullocks, the CPI's ears of corn and sickle…) and candidates were printed with their symbols on the ballot. A voter who could not read a name could still recognise a picture. It made universal franchise actually workable.
  - **The patience it took:** polling ran in phases from October 1951 to February 1952; counting took even longer. Officials trekked to villages with ballot boxes — in some places polling booths were set up within kilometres of every settlement.

A SCHOOL THAT STARTS WITH THE EXAM

Think of India in 1951 as a school that decided to hold final exams on DAY ONE — before teaching a single class. Most countries teach democracy for generations, then slowly let citizens vote. India let every citizen vote first, trusting elections themselves to teach democracy. The symbols system was the "open book": you did not need to read the whole paper, you only needed to recognise the picture of the party you trusted.

The Three Elections and Their Verdicts

The first three general elections built the rhythm of Indian democracy. Watch the same pattern three times — a giant Congress win — and one big exception where the pattern cracked.

Election	Congress seats	What it proved	Opposition picture
First, 1951-52	364 of 489 (about 74%)	Universal franchise works; a poor, mostly illiterate electorate votes decisively	CPI 16 — the largest opposition; Socialists 12; KMPP 9

Election	Congress seats	What it proved	Opposition picture
Second, 1957	371 of 494	Dominance was not a one-off — it repeated	CPI 27 — and it WINS Kerala; PSP 19; Jana Sangh 4
Third, 1962	361 of 494	Dominance dips but holds; the opposition bench widens	CPI 29; Swatantra 18; Jana Sangh 14; PSP 12

- **First general election (October 1951 - February 1952):**
  - **Congress 364 of 489 seats** with about 45% of the votes — Nehru became the first elected Prime Minister of free India.
  - **The vote-share puzzle (a favourite question):** 45% of votes produced 74% of seats. Under the **first-past-the-post** system the winner in each constituency takes the seat with a simple lead, so a big nationwide vote lead converts into a far bigger seat lead.
  - **Second largest party:** the **Communist Party of India (16 seats)** — not any socialist party.
  - **Nehru's own margin:** he won from Allahabad (and Phulpur) by lakhs of votes — his campaigning pulled whole states toward Congress.
- **Second general election (1957):**
  - **Congress 371 of 494** — the dominance repeated. Nehru continued as Prime Minister.
  - **The shock headline:** in **Kerala**, the **Communist Party of India won the state assembly** and **E.M.S. Namboodiripad** became Chief Minister — the **first government anywhere in the world to come to power through open, democratic elections on a communist programme**.
  - **The EMS ministry's agenda:** the Land Reforms Act (ending tenancy exploitation) and an Education Bill (regulating private schools) — landowners and religious bodies fought back hard.
  - **1959 — the dismissal:** after violent protests (the "liberation struggle" backed by opposition parties and religious groups), the Centre **asked the Governor for a report and imposed President's rule** — the first time an ELECTED state government was dismissed this way. Kerala became a permanent exam question: 1957 victory, 1959 dismissal.
- **Third general election (1962):**
  - **Congress 361 of 494** — about 20 seats fewer than 1957, but still a massive majority.
  - **The opposition bench matured:** CPI 29, Swatantra 18 (first election after its 1959 founding), Jana Sangh 14, PSP 12 — four organised blocs instead of scattered individuals.
  - **The era's rule:** Congress dominance lasted unbroken from 1952 to **1967** — the year the pattern finally broke (a later chapter).

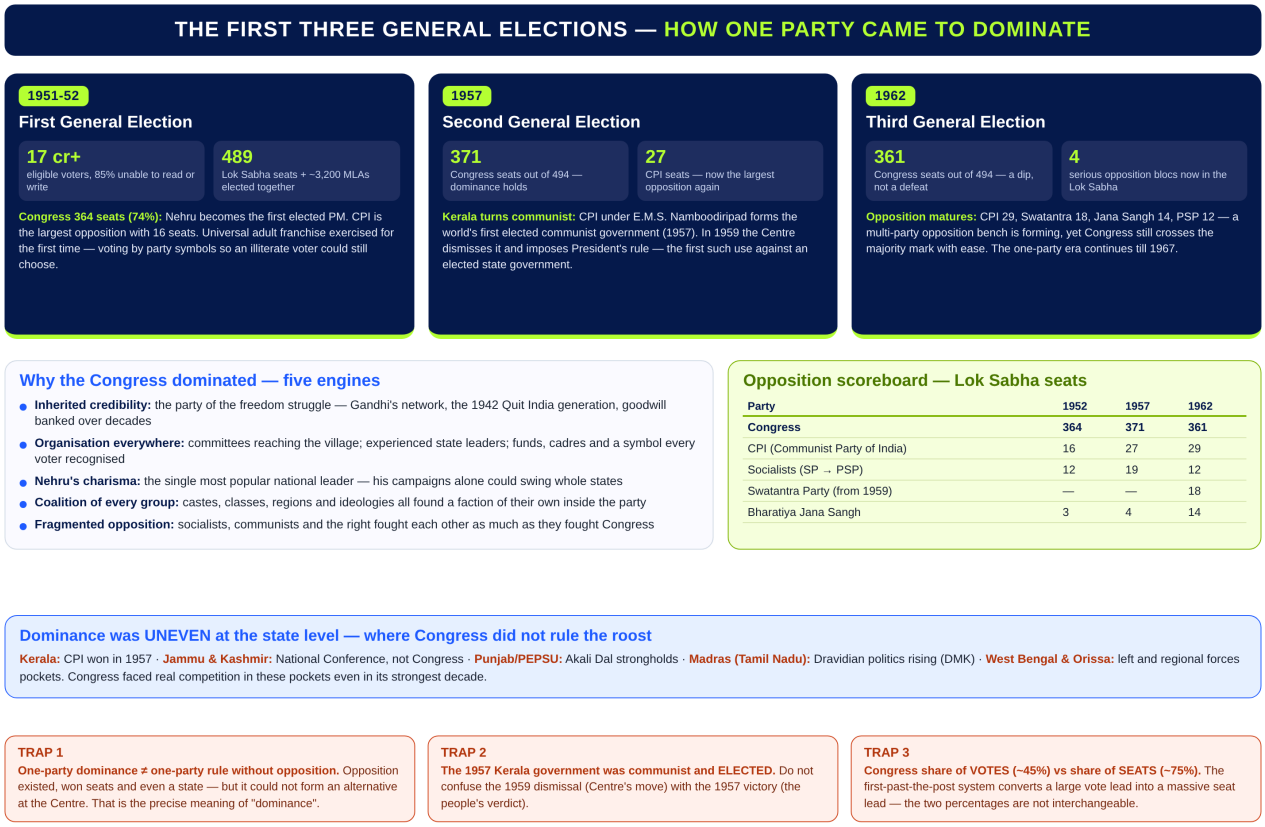


Figure 1: The first three general elections side by side: scale, Congress verdicts, the Kerala break, the five engines of dominance, the opposition scoreboard and the traps.

Why One Party Dominated: The National Level

A visitor from 1950 would ask the obvious question: how does ONE party win three elections in a row across a country of continental size? The answer is not one reason but five engines pulling together — and understanding each one is exactly what the questions test.

- **Engine 1 — inherited credibility:**
  - The Congress was not a new party — it **led the freedom struggle for over 60 years** before 1947.
  - Its leaders had gone to jail, its martyrs were household names, and the Quit India generation (1942) had the freshness of sacrifice behind it.
  - Ordinary families banked decades of goodwill: the party that got the British out deserved the chance to run the country. No rival could match that biography.
- **Engine 2 — an organisation that reached every village:**
  - Congress had **committees from the national level down to the village level** — a machine no opposition could copy quickly.
  - It had funds, full-time workers, and **experienced leaders in every province** who knew local issues and local languages.
  - **State bosses** (powerful regional leaders with their own networks) delivered their state's votes to the national party.
- **Engine 3 — Nehru's charisma:**

- Nehru was **the single most popular leader in the country** — the "prince of the freedom struggle" whose speeches drew sea-sized crowds.
- His campaign visits alone could swing constituencies; voters voted "for Nehru" even when they knew little about the local Congress candidate.
- **But note the balance:** Nehru's charm mattered, yet Congress kept winning in localities where his name meant little — the organisation and the social coalition did the daily work.

- **Engine 4 — the coalition of every social group:**
  - Upper castes, middle peasants, workers, Dalits, tribals, minorities — **every large group found a faction of Congress speaking for it** (detailed in the "coalitional nature" section below).
  - Where else would a particular community go, if its own spokesmen sat inside the ruling party?
- **Engine 5 — a fragmented opposition:**
  - Socialists, communists and the right-wing were **ideological rivals of each other first** — they split the anti-Congress vote instead of uniting it.
  - Most were young parties (Jana Sangh 1951, Swatantra 1959) still building machines; none could offer a credible alternative government at the Centre in this era.

THE CONGRESS SYSTEM — RAJNI KOTHARI'S MODEL

Political scientist **Rajni Kothari** named the pattern of this era the **Congress system**. Learn its three parts as three lines:

- **One party of dominance:** Congress won elections AND set the national agenda — but its dominance ran on **consensus and inclusion**, not on force or rigging.
- **Parties of pressure:** opposition parties could not form the government, so they worked as **pressure groups** — pushing Congress from outside, or bargaining with factions inside it.
- **Competition inside, not outside:** the real contest for power happened **within Congress between factions** — which is why defection from Congress was rare and opposition growth was slow.

- **Dominance with democracy — the point examiners reward:**
  - Elections were **genuinely free**: opposition parties campaigned openly, criticised Nehru to his face, and won state power in Kerala.
  - **Nehru respected verdicts:** he accepted Kerala's communist win as legitimate — "the people's choice" — though his government still dismissed it in 1959, a tension worth remembering.
  - Dominance rested on **agreement and performance**, which is why historians call it "one-party dominance", never "one-party rule".

Uneven Dominance: The State Level

The national map was all Congress blue — but zoom into the states and the picture patches. The syllabus line "uneven dominance at the state level" is exactly this: Congress did NOT rule uncontested everywhere, and naming these pockets earns the marks.

State / region	Who challenged Congress	What happened
Kerala	Communist Party of India	Won the 1957 assembly election; E.M.S. Namboodiripad headed the world's first elected communist government; dismissed by President's rule in 1959
Jammu & Kashmir	National Conference	Sheikh Abdullah's party, not Congress, dominated the state's politics through this era — a special constitutional context (Article 370)
Punjab & PEPSU	Akali Dal	The Akali Dal anchored Sikh religious-regional politics; Congress coalitions here were fragile and negotiated
Madras (later Tamil Nadu)	Dravidian movement (rising DMK)	The anti-Hindi, anti-Congress Dravidian upsurge grew through the 1950s; DMK's first big breakthroughs came at the end of the era
West Bengal & Orissa	Left groups; Ganatantra Parishad	Left parties and the regional Ganatantra Parishad (Orissa) kept Congress below sweeps in pockets of the east

- **Why the variation existed:**
  - **Strong regional identities** (Kerala's class politics, Kashmir's special status, Punjab's Sikh politics, Madras's language politics) gave voters a non-Congress option with local roots.
  - **Where local Congress bosses were strong and factions were settled,** Congress swept; where factions fought openly, rivals slipped in.
  - **The lesson the era taught:** Congress dominance was a **national average, not a uniform** — and 1967 would prove the exceptions were the future.

The Coalitional Nature of Congress

This is the section where most students lose marks by writing only "Congress was popular". The deeper answer: Congress won BECAUSE it was not one party in the ordinary sense — it was a **coalition**, an umbrella under which India's entire social and ideological spectrum found shelter.

- **The ideological rainbow:**
  - Congress housed **socialists and Gandhians** (who wanted land reform and village uplift), **conservatives and landlords' sons** (who feared both), **traditionalists** and **modernisers** — all at once.
  - Nehru preached socialism from the podium while state bosses protected landlord interests in the districts — and BOTH stayed inside the party. Conflict existed, but it never had to leave the house.
- **The social rainbow:**
  - **Castes:** dominant peasant castes and upper castes held most tickets, but Dalits and minorities got their share of nominations.
  - **Classes:** industrialists funded it; peasants voted for it; workers bargained with it.
  - **Regions:** every state's local elite joined — so every state felt Congress was "theirs" too.
- **Factions — the engine room:**
  - Each state had its **bosses and camps**; the high command distributed tickets to BALANCE factions, not to reward the single strongest one.
  - **Why factions mattered so much:** with no realistic chance of defeating Congress from outside, ambitious politicians fought for tickets and posts INSIDE it. Losing a Congress ticket was a bigger catastrophe than losing an election as an independent.
  - This is the precise meaning of "coalitional nature": **groups competed for power within the umbrella instead of leaving it.**

THE BIG JOINT FAMILY

Congress was like a large joint family before the split: parents, uncles, cousins and in-laws all living under one roof, quarrelling over the kitchen but eating at one table. The mapping: each faction = a family branch; tickets and ministries = the shared kitchen; leaving the family = political suicide because the family name (Congress) opened every door. The family stayed huge BECAUSE staying was profitable — and this is also why its eventual split (1969) shook the whole political system.

- **Why this nature sustained dominance:**
  - **Absorption:** new demands (farmers' grievances, language movements, caste assertions) were pulled INSIDE and given a faction — defusing them before they became rival parties.
  - **Consensus culture:** decisions were bargained, not imposed; even Nehru lost votes inside his own party sometimes and accepted it.
  - **The cost (remember this too):** consensus meant SLOW decisions — radical land reform or caste reform died in committee. The umbrella was wide but heavy.

Major Opposition Parties: Who They Were and What They Wanted

Opposition in this era was small in seats but big in ideas. Four parties matter. Learn founder + year + core idea + programme for each — the questions ask exactly these four slots.

- **The Socialists — Socialist Party to Praja Socialist Party (PSP):**

- **Who:** Jayaprakash Narayan (JP), Ram Manohar Lohia, S.M. Joshi — the socialist wing that LEFT Congress in 1948 rather than stay inside.
- **The merger:** the **Socialist Party** merged with Kripalani's **Kisan Mazdoor Praja Party (KMPP)** in 1952 to form the **Praja Socialist Party (PSP)**.
- **Idea: democratic socialism** — a "third force" between Congress's mixed economy and communism; land reform, workers' rights, civil liberties, decentralisation.
- **Record:** 12 seats (1952), 19 (1957), 12 (1962) — never a government, but a constant ideological goad.

- **The Communist Party of India (CPI):**
  - **Who:** founded in 1925; India's OLDEST opposition in this era.
  - **The crossroads:** after 1947 it debated revolution vs elections; the **1951 party programme chose constitutional, electoral methods** — a decision the next six years would vindicate.
  - **Landmark: Kerala 1957** — the world's first elected communist government (see above).
  - **Record:** 16 seats (1952), 27 (1957), 29 (1962) — the **largest opposition party through the whole era**. Its base: workers, tenants, and the countryside of Kerala, Bengal and Andhra.
  - **Looking ahead:** in 1964 the party SPLIT — the breakaway became the CPI(M).
- **Bharatiya Jana Sangh (BJS):**
  - **Who:** founded in **1951 by Syama Prasad Mookerjee**; with roots in RSS-backed nationalism; later led intellectually by Deendayal Upadhyaya.
  - **Idea: one country, one nation, one culture** — India as a nation rooted in Hindu cultural unity.
  - **Programme:** integration of Jammu & Kashmir fully into India, replacement of English with Hindi, a uniform civil code, and an end to special treatment of minorities.
  - **Record:** 3 seats (1952), 4 (1957), 14 (1962) — small nationally, but a strong base in parts of the Hindi belt and a seedbed of later politics.
- **Swatantra Party:**
  - **Who:** founded in **1959 by C. Rajagopalachari (Rajaji)** — former Governor-General — with N.G. Ranga and K.M. Munshi.
  - **Idea: free enterprise and minimal state control** — the classic right-of-centre, classical-liberal response to the licence raj.
  - **Programme:** end permits and controls, keep the private sector free, protect property, and rethink non-alignment toward closer Western ties.
  - **Record:** 18 seats in 1962 (its first election) — immediately the second-largest opposition bloc after CPI.

Party	Founded by / year	Core idea	Signature demand
PSP (Socialists)	JP Narayan & Lohia; SP 1948, PSP 1952 merger	Democratic socialism — the "third force"	Land reform, decentralisation, civil liberties

Party	Founded by / year	Core idea	Signature demand
CPI	Founded 1925; 1951 programme chose elections	Class politics; constitutional road to power	Land to the tenant, workers' rights
Jana Sangh	Syama Prasad Mookerjee, 1951	One country, one nation, one culture	Full integration of Kashmir, Hindi, uniform civil code
Swatantra	C. Rajagopalachari, 1959	Free enterprise against state control	End the licence-permit raj

What the Opposition Actually Achieved

Do not measure this opposition only in seats — the syllabus and examiners reward you for its FUNCTION in the system.

- **Parties of pressure — Kothari's point in action:**
  - Socialists could not pass laws, but their campaigns **pushed land reform and community development up Congress's own agenda**.
  - Swatantra could not end planning, but its free-market critique **sharpened every economic debate** of the 1960s.
  - Opposition pressure worked THROUGH Congress factions — allied groups inside the umbrella bargained on their behalf.
- **Proving alternatives are possible:**
  - **Kerala 1957** showed a non-Congress party could win a whole state and run a government — a psychological break in the "Congress is inevitable" belief.
  - **1959 dismissal** showed the limits: the Centre could still remove such governments. Both facts together form the exam-ready answer.
- **Broadening the national debate:**
  - **Jana Sangh** forced cultural-nationalist questions (Kashmir, Hindi, uniform civil code) into mainstream debate.
  - **CPI** organised workers and tenants into national politics and kept class issues alive.
  - **The seed of 1967:** these scattered streams would regroup after 1967 — the same parties that later fought together (and against each other) in coalition politics.

Key Facts & Terms: One-Stop Revision

ERA OF ONE-PARTY DOMINANCE — EVERY FACT ON ONE PAGE

Term / fact	Meaning / statement	Exam use
Universal adult franchise	Every adult 21+ votes — no property, literacy or gender bar (Article 326)	Franchise questions; the "why remarkable" answer
First general election	Oct 1951 - Feb 1952; 17 cr+ voters, 85% illiterate; 489 LS + 3,200 MLAs elected together	Scale and symbol-system questions
Sukumar Sen	First Chief Election Commissioner; ran the 1951-52 exercise	Person-matching questions
Symbols	Party/candidate pictures on ballots so non-readers could vote	How-franchise-worked answers
Congress 1952 / 1957 / 1962	364 of 489 / 371 of 494 / 361 of 494 seats; 45% of votes	Result-matching questions
First-past-the-post	Simple lead wins the seat; converts 45% votes into 74% seats	Votes-vs-seats trap questions
Largest opposition	CPI — 16, 27, 29 seats across the three elections	"second largest party" answers
Kerala 1957	CPI under E.M.S. Namboodiripad — world's first elected communist government	Landmark-matching questions
Kerala 1959	Centre imposed President's rule — first elected state government dismissed	Sequence questions (1957 win, 1959 dismissal)
Congress system	Rajni Kothari: one dominant party + opposition as parties of pressure + competition inside factions	"who described" and model questions
Coalitional nature	Ideological + social rainbow; factions fight INSIDE the umbrella; absorption of demands	"nature of Congress" answers
State-level exceptions	Kerala (CPI), J&K (National Conference), Punjab/PEPSU (Akali Dal), Madras (DMK rising), WB-Orissa (left)	"uneven dominance" answers
PSP	Socialist Party + Kripalani's KMPP merged 1952; JP Narayan, Lohia; democratic socialism	Merger-matching questions

Term / fact	Meaning / statement	Exam use
Jana Sangh	S.P. Mookerjee 1951; one country one nation one culture; Kashmir, Hindi, UCC	Programme-matching questions
Swatantra	C. Rajagopalachari 1959; free enterprise; end licence raj; 18 seats in 1962	Founder-and-year questions

Common Errors & Special Cases

THE TRAPS THIS UNIT SETS — READ BEFORE THE MOCK

The rule you assume	The twist	The trap in the question
"One-party dominance = no opposition"	Opposition won seats in all three elections and even a state government	Definition-precision questions
"45% votes = 45% seats"	First-past-the-post turned 45% of votes into 74% of seats	Vote-share vs seat-share questions
"Communists seized power in Kerala"	CPI WON an election in 1957 — the seizure word is wrong; the DISMISSAL came from the Centre in 1959	Verb-choice traps
"Swatantra fought in 1952"	Founded 1959 — its first election was 1962	Party-year matching
"The Socialists and Congress were allies"	They LEFT Congress in 1948 and opposed it — though socialist ideas pushed Congress policy	Party-history questions
"Congress dominated every state"	Kerala, J&K, Punjab-PEPSU, Madras, WB pockets resisted through the era	"uneven dominance" questions
"Kothari = a Congress leader"	Rajni Kothari was the political SCIENTIST who named the Congress system	"who said what" questions

The rule you assume	The twist	The trap in the question
"Franchise came after literacy"	India gave the vote FIRST and schooling later — the reverse sequence is the point	"why remarkable" questions
"Congress = socialist party"	It contained socialists AND conservatives — the umbrella, not one ideology, is the answer	"nature of Congress" questions
"CPI founded after independence"	The CPI dates to 1925 — only its 1951 programme is post-independence	Party-year matching

The 60-Second Self-Test

Cover the answers, say each one aloud, then check. If any answer takes longer than ten seconds, revisit that section.

- **When were the first general elections held and what was their scale?** → October 1951 - February 1952; 17 crore+ voters, 489 Lok Sabha + about 3,200 MLAs.
- **Why were symbols printed on ballots?** → About 85% of voters could not read — pictures made universal franchise workable.
- **Congress seats in 1952 / 1957 / 1962?** → 364 of 489; 371 of 494; 361 of 494.
- **Which party was the largest opposition in all three elections?** → CPI (16, 27, 29 seats).
- **What happened in Kerala in 1957 and 1959?** → 1957: CPI under EMS Namboodiripad formed the world's first elected communist government; 1959: the Centre dismissed it and imposed President's rule.
- **Who founded the Swatantra Party, when, and with what idea?** → C. Rajagopalachari, 1959 — free enterprise against the licence raj.
- **Name the four major opposition parties with one founder each.** → Socialists (JP Narayan/Lohia), CPI (1925), Jana Sangh (S.P. Mookerjee, 1951), Swatantra (Rajaji, 1959).
- **State the Congress system in one line.** → One dominant party of consensus + opposition parties working as pressure + real competition inside factions.
- **Why was the Congress called a coalition?** → It housed many ideologies, castes and classes as factions — groups fought for power INSIDE the umbrella instead of leaving it.
- **Which states escaped Congress sweeps in this era?** → Kerala (CPI), J&K (National Conference), Punjab-PEPSU (Akali Dal), Madras (DMK rising), West Bengal and Orissa pockets (left).

The Whole Chapter in One Picture



Figure 2: Chapter mindmap: elections, the nature of dominance, uneven state-level hold, the coalitional umbrella, the four opposition parties and their function — with the traps that catch most students.

Practice Questions (Exam Pattern)

Ten questions in the CUET UG style. Attempt all of them — the paper gives +5 for each correct answer and −1 for every incorrect answer.

Q1. The first general elections in India were held in:

(A) 1950-51 (B) 1951-52
(C) 1952-53 (D) 1954-55

Q2. The first Chief Election Commissioner of India was:

(A) Sukumar Sen (B) T.N. Seshan
(C) K.V.K. Sundaram (D) B.B. Lyngdoh

Q3. In the first Lok Sabha (1952), the second-largest party after the Congress was:

(A) Praja Socialist Party (B) Bharatiya Jana Sangh
(C) Communist Party of India (D) Swatantra Party

Q4. The world's first government to come to power through democratic elections on a communist programme was formed in 1957 in:

(A) West Bengal **(B)** Andhra Pradesh
(C) Kerala **(D)** Tripura

Q5. The Swatantra Party was founded in 1959 by:

(A) Jayaprakash Narayan **(B)** Syama Prasad Mookerjee
(C) Ram Manohar Lohia **(D)** C. Rajagopalachari

Q6. "One country, one nation, one culture" was the core idea of:

(A) the Communist Party of India **(B)** the Praja Socialist Party
(C) the Bharatiya Jana Sangh **(D)** the Swatantra Party

Q7. In the 1952 election the Congress won about 45% of the votes but about 74% of the Lok Sabha seats. The main reason is:

(A) opposition parties did not campaign **(B)** the first-past-the-post system converts vote leads into much larger seat shares
(C) the elections were rigged **(D)** a large section of voters could not vote

Q8. The "Congress system" — one dominant party with opposition acting as parties of pressure — was described by:

(A) Rajni Kothari **(B)** Granville Austin
(C) Paul Brass **(D)** Myron Weiner

Q9. In 1959 the elected communist government of Kerala was removed when:

(A) fresh elections were called on the Chief Minister's advice **(B)** the assembly passed a no-confidence motion
(C) the Supreme Court struck down the ministry **(D)** the Centre imposed President's rule on the basis of the Governor's report

Q10. The Socialist Party and the Kisan Mazdoor Praja Party merged in 1952 to form:

(A) the Janata Party **(B)** the Praja Socialist Party
(C) the Samyukta Socialist Party **(D)** the Bharatiya Lok Dal

Detailed Solutions

Each solution shows the reasoning, not just the verdict — cover the answer line, attempt the question, then compare.

Sol. Q1. Polling ran in phases from October 1951 to February 1952 — the first election on universal adult franchise. 1950 saw the Election Commission's creation, not the polling.

Answer: (B)

Sol. Q2. Sukumar Sen administered the giant 1951-52 exercise, including the symbol system for illiterate voters. T.N. Seshan is a later Chief Election Commissioner (1990s) — a deliberate distractor.

Answer: (A)

Sol. Q3. CPI won 16 seats in 1952 — the largest opposition. The Socialists contested as two separate parties (SP 12 + KMPP 9) and merged into the PSP only after the election; Swatantra did not exist until 1959, and Jana Sangh won only 3.

Answer: (C)

Sol. Q4. Kerala 1957: E.M.S. Namboodiripad headed the first government anywhere elected on a communist programme. West Bengal's Left Front governments came only in 1977 — a time-gap distractor.

Answer: (C)

Sol. Q5. C. Rajagopalachari (Rajaji) — former Governor-General — founded Swatantra in 1959 with N.G. Ranga and K.M. Munshi, on free enterprise against the licence raj.

Answer: (D)

Sol. Q6. The Jana Sangh (1951, Syama Prasad Mookerjee) built its politics on cultural unity — one country, one nation, one culture — with Kashmir integration, Hindi and a uniform civil code as signature demands.

Answer: (C)

Sol. Q7. Under first-past-the-post, whoever leads a constituency takes the whole seat. Congress led widely but modestly almost everywhere, so 45% of votes compounded into 74% of seats. The elections were free — option C is the classic wrong reflex.

Answer: (B)

Sol. Q8. Political scientist Rajni Kothari named the pattern the Congress system: a party of dominance plus parties of pressure, with real competition inside Congress factions. Granville Austin wrote on the Constitution — a deliberate distractor.

Answer: (A)

Sol. Q9. In 1959 the Centre, on the Governor's report over the liberation-struggle protests, imposed President's rule — the first dismissal of an elected state government. No no-confidence motion or court ruling was involved.

Answer: (D)

Sol. Q10. The Socialist Party (JP Narayan, Lohia) merged with Kripalani's Kisan Mazdoor Praja Party in 1952 to form the Praja Socialist Party. The Janata Party belongs to 1977 — a different era.

Answer: (B)

Wrong-Answer Clinic — the one-line corrections

Dropped marks above? Find your slip here and rewrite the corrected rule in your own words.

If you answered...	Your slip was...	The corrected rule, in one line
Q1 option A	Confusing the EC's founding year with polling	EC: January 1950; election: October 1951 - February 1952
Q3 option A	Merging the PSP before it existed	In 1952 the Socialists contested as SP + KMPP, merging DURING the year — CPI (16) was the largest opposition
Q4 option A	Importing West Bengal's 1977 Left Front backwards	Kerala 1957 is the landmark; Bengal comes two decades later
Q5 option B	Swapping Jana Sangh's founder into Swatantra	Mookerjee founded Jana Sangh (1951); Rajaji founded Swatantra (1959)
Q7 option C	Reading dominance as rigging	The elections were free; the seat bonus is the voting system's arithmetic
Q9 option C	Assuming an assembly-level removal	The removal was the CENTRE's move — President's rule on the Governor's report

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